

Color Tokens and Dark Mode Report

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Site Details

Here is the URL to my [Live practice Site](#).

Reflection

Deriving Dark Mode Values

I chose dark mode values by hand instead of using `color-mix()` because dark mode needs more than just a darker version of the light colors. The colors have to stay readable, have enough contrast, and still feel balanced on a dark background. If I used `color-mix()` automatically, I would gain consistency and speed because the dark colors could be generated from the same seed values. It would also make the system easier to update if the brand color changed.

However, I would lose some control. A mathematically generated dark color is not always the best visual choice. Some colors may become too dull, too bright, or not have enough contrast. By choosing the dark values by hand, I can make sure the background, text, links, borders, and accent colors actually work well together in real use.

Understanding `color-mix()` Percentages

The percentage in `color-mix()` represents how much of the seed color is being included in the mix. In this example:

```
1 --accent-200: color-mix(in oklch, var(--seed) 30%, white);--accent-400: color-mix(in oklch, var(--seed) 75%, white);
```

`accent-200` uses only 30% of the seed color and mixes the rest with white. That means it has more white in it, so it becomes lighter. `accent-400` uses 75% of the seed color, so it keeps more of the original color and has less white mixed in. That makes it stronger and darker than `accent-200`.

Looking Back

One thing I understand better now is that CSS colors are not just single fixed values. A good color system uses raw seed colors and semantic tokens so the design can adapt across different contexts. Before this unit, I mostly thought of colors as direct values like `#ffffff` or `green`. Now I understand that a token like `--color-surface` is more flexible because it can mean a light card background in light mode and a dark card background in dark mode. This makes the whole site easier to maintain and update.